# Project Description

The problem space selected for our project is that of health and wellbeing. University students have been chosen as the most suitable target audience for our project due to our understanding of the demographic as-well as our ease of access to interviews and observations. As university students ourselves, we have recognised that a proceeding issue amongst the group is that of stress relating to time management. Much of this stress comes from the medial tasks in which we have to perform at home that eat into time that could be spent more productively. For this reason, the problem statement of "How can we convenience university students in regards to their daily routine" has been decided upon.

The project itself is an application designed to pick out a user's outfit for the day based on the weather and the users available clothing options. Information regarding the weather will be sourced through public databases online with decisions made by the application being based on conditions such as rain and temperature. The application will take into account the climate for the rest of the day, adjusting its suggestions for temperamental weather. The clothing options for each user will be selected from those in which the user inputs themselves. Users will enter essential information about each item they input along with the relative position of the item in their closet. An image will also need to be uploaded as this will be displayed when the article of clothing is selected by the application. Users can favourite specific outfits suggested, being able to view these on library along with the weather conditions they wore said outfit in previously.

To guide the development of our application seven distinct phases have been decide upon. They are as follows:

*Table 1: Phases of Development*

| Phase | Description |
|---|---|
| Project Definition | - An outline of the application and its features are formed<br>- Research conducted for the design and problem space |
| User Research | - User Interviews conducted on UQ campus<br>- User observations on inappropriate clothing choices |
| Low Fidelity Prototype | - Paper prototype designed based on research |
| User Testing | - Users are lightly guided through the paper prototype<br>- Notes taken on user interactions and suggestions |
| Medium Fidelity Prototype | - Basic version of the application<br>- Improvements from low fidelity prototype based on |
| User Testing | - Another round of user testing, this time on the medium fidelity prototype<br>- Notes on final improvements taken |
| Final Product | - The final product for this course is produced taking into account the previous suggestions |

# Ethical Issues

For this project there are a multitude of ethical issues that either could or will arise as a result of its' development. Below is a table listing both a description of the issue along with an action plan in order to resolve it.

*Table 2: Ethical Issues*

| Development Phase | Description of Issue | Action Plan |
|---|---|---|
| User Research | **Invasive Questioning:**<br><br>During the interviews it is essential that boundaries are kept and certain topics are avoided. This is particularly important for our project as personal topics such as daily routine, fashion preferences and so forth are essential for us to capture. | To minimise this issue, it is essential that consent is obtained from a user as-well as upholding anonymity. A consent form should be provided to the interviewee before the interview is conducted. In which the nature of the interview and the topics to be focused upon should be disclosed. |
| User Research | **Bias and Representation:**<br><br>While our group is diverse, consisting of a range of backgrounds and characteristics, it is still possible that bias's persist. These biases can become more prevalent if we only interview people who share the same perspectives and experiences as we do. | Interviews must be conducted with a highly diverse set of individuals. This is so an accurate depiction of the needs of university students can be created along with eliminating as much bias as possible. Our questions must not be leading in order to ensure their responses are not be influenced by our own bias's. |
| User Testing | **Misleading Representation:**<br><br>Features will not be fully developed when user testing is conducted. This leads to the possibility that user might be mislead as to how certain features might function. This risk is greatest with the paper prototype which, while offering a visual representation of the application, cannot properly depict its functionality. User might give poor feedback because of this, providing positive feedback for functions which work well on paper but | Group members must be present and attentive while testing is conducted. This includes helping walk users through the application as well as properly explaining functions and their purposes when needed. |

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| | poorly when incorporated into the actual application. | |
| Final Product | **Data Security:**<br><br>In order for our application to work it will need to have access to a verity of personal information about its users. The items owned by a user along with their preferences and location can all be considered to be sensitive information, making potential data breaches quite dangerous. | Data stored by the application must not be shared to any external sources. Users will be notified in the application as to what information is being kept about them and the fact that it will not be shared. |
| Final Product | **Promote Consumerism:**<br><br>Being an application revolving around outfits and clothing it is possible that it could influence users to increasing their purchasing habits. This is particularly damaging for the target audience we've selected, as university students typically lack financial stability. | The application should in no way promote new clothing items. It will be made clear that its purpose is for the convenience and wellbeing of users. |
| Final Product | **Personal Expression Diminished:**<br><br>By selecting outfits for users, the application could erase the users' ability to express themselves. Students might be pressured to conform to societal norms by the application, negatively impacting their individuality. | The applications favouriting feature will help to eradicate this. By favoriting certain outfits, the algorithm used to select outfits will be altered, providing more outfits which conform to the favorited style. |
| Final Product | **Environmental Issues:**<br><br>The application could promote fast fashion in which user will begin buying and discarding clothes frequently. Most of these clothing items are made from non-sustainable materials. The fashion industry already contributes heavily to global pollution. | The application will have a wear and care tips page, which provides users with information on how to take care of certain clothing items. |

# Principles of Ethics

Informed consent is arguably the most crucial ethical principal that will be abided by during the conduction of interviews. As stated by Amy Bruckman, "as soon as the participant observer asks explicit questions about the environment for research purposes, then informed consent is required" (Bruckman, 2014). Interviews to be ethical must maintain a

high level of respect towards the interviewee and their privacy, so along with consent confidentiality must also be upheld (Heggen & Guillemin, 2012). With the application itself beneficence is an ethical standard, meaning the application should aim to keep the users' best interests at heart (Beauchamp, 2008). As a means of achieving beneficence, transparency will be employed in regards to every feature of the app. Since personalization is a key aspect of the application, it is essential that users are informed as to what information is being kept and how it is being used in order to avoid breaching personal boundaries (Diakopoulos, 2016). Justice if often considered to be one of the most important pillars in ethics and must therefore be represented by any system wanting to operate ethically. An underpinning element of justice is that of equality (Velasquez et al, 1990). Due to this creating an equal and fair platform is a priority for our team when developing our project.

With all of these principles considered our project will have a pronounced positive effect on the daily lives of its users. University students will become more time efficient in regards to their daily routines, providing them with more time to spend in other aspects of their life. This could potentially improve students' mental wellbeing's and lifestyles as it promotes more effective time management (Wang et al, 2011). A drop in weather related inconvenience and injury can also be expected thanks to the apps algorithm which takes weather into account. Potential downsides to the app are also present. University students already spend excessive amounts of time using technology, with studies finding a correlation between this addiction and poor performance at school (Sert et al, 2019). Introducing another application which engages students with their phone might exacerbate said issue.

# References


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